

Introduction

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Coaching could be seen as a human development process that involves structured, focused interaction and the use of appropriate strategies, tools and techniques to promote desirable and sustainable change for the benefit of the coachee and potentially for other stakeholders. Its popularity is indisputable, and across all economic sectors an increasing number of organizations are commissioning coaches to support their staff at different stages in their careers. Coaching is therefore recognized as a powerful vehicle for increasing performance, achieving results and optimizing personal effectiveness. Because it has proved to be so effective, many companies and government departments invest in internal and external coaching for their employees. The work of independent coaches is flourishing, enabling clients to accomplish their goals, both professionally and personally.

As the field of coaching has developed, existing models of coaching have begun to be applied in wider contexts, used with diverse client groups and with different media. Coaching practitioners come from a variety of professions and often from multi-theoretical backgrounds. They constantly bring new dimensions to the field via the adaptation of concepts, ideas and practical tools developed in their 'home' traditions and through interdisciplinarity. It is possible to meet coaches whose philosophies and practices of coaching would have very little in common, although their aims and purposes may be similar.

In this book, we recognize that coaching is an applied field of practice that has its intellectual roots in a range of disciplines: social psychology; learning theory; theories of human and organizational development; and existential and phenomenological philosophy, to name just a few. This diversity of the field creates exciting opportunities for meaningful interaction and mutual enrichment but there is also the potential for confusion, particularly for novices in the

field and for buyers of coaching. Questions that may be asked include: What is the difference between existential coaching and solution-focused coaching? What would a performance coach do differently from a developmental coach? Is it possible to compare psychodynamic coaching with life coaching? Could a Gestalt-trained coach be a good choice in career coaching? Until now, there were no resource books in the field that could help practitioners and other stakeholders to find comprehensive answers to these types of questions. In this book we aim to address this gap by clarifying not only the differences between the theoretical approaches to coaching but also the differences and links between these perspectives in relation to the genres and contexts of coaching.

In this introduction there are three sections. The first section discusses coaching in terms of its identity, definition and role in organizations. In the second section we discuss the knowledge base of coaching and identify adult learning theory as an important theoretical tradition underpinning coaching. In the third section we explain the matrix structure of the book. We conclude with short summaries for each chapter and brief guidance on how to read the book.

I. THE IDENTITY OF COACHING

Discussions about identity usually begin with an historical overview of how the term came into usage and how the meaning has developed over time. According to the Online Etymology Dictionary, the word ‘coach’ derives from a town called ‘Kocs’ in northern Hungary, where horse drawn carriages were made. The meaning of coach as an instructor or trainer is purportedly from around 1830, when it was Oxford University slang for a tutor who ‘carried’ a student through an exam; the term coaching was later applied in the 1800s to improving the performance of athletes.

In the twentieth century, coaching found its way into the workplace, where it was associated with a specific process of education for young recruits. The coach was typically a more experienced employee, often with managerial authority over them. He or she would typically demonstrate a task, instruct them to attempt the same task, observe their performance, and provide feedback based either on their own experience, or a standardized perception of performance. Coach and coachee (usually called trainee or apprentice) would then discuss the feedback and plan how the coachee would approach the task differently next time. In essence, this form of coaching has much in common with instruction. Where instruction and coaching clearly differ in this model is the transition from assignment of task and extrinsic observation (by the coach) to self-managed experimentation and intrinsic observation (by the coachee). We have no reliable information that would allow us to identify what proportion of coaching today fits this approach.

The concept and application of coaching has since mushroomed into a panoply of models and approaches, many of which are more non-directive in nature. The distinction between directive and non-directive approaches is shown in Table 0.1.

Table 0.1: Transitions from traditional coaching

<i>From</i>	<i>To</i>
Coach requires expertise/knowledge of the task	Coach requires expertise/knowledge of the coaching process
Driven by the coach's agenda, or at best an agreed agenda	Driven by the coachee's agenda
Coachee performance (doing)	Coachee self-actualization (becoming)
Skills acquisition (building knowledge of the task)	Capability development (building insight and self-knowledge as stepping stones to more substantive change)
Meeting standards set by others	Meeting standards set by the coachee

A next step in identifying what coaching is would be to try to provide a definition of it. Coaching books invariably begin with some kind of definition that identifies coaching as a helping strategy, designed to enable people to reach their full potential. It appears, however, that these definitions are not definitive enough to distinguish coaching from its close neighbours – mentoring, counselling and training – as these other forms of helping all make similar claims.

Attempts to define coaching usually try to make it distinctive in terms of ultimate purpose (what it is for?), type of clients (who uses this service?) or process (how it is done?) or a combination of these. In relation to an ultimate purpose coaching is often described as aiming at individual development or ‘enhancing well-being and performance’ (Grant & Palmer, 2002). These types of definitions are difficult to dispute but they cannot differentiate coaching from counselling or mentoring or even training, because essentially their purposes are the same. The initial attempts (Grant, 2000) to define coaching as designed for the ‘mentally healthy’ clientele group are now seen as unsatisfactory for many practical and ethical reasons. Attempts to define coaching on the basis of a distinct process are similarly problematic. Not only do they include some characteristics that cannot distinguish coaching from other helping professions, they also include characteristics that are so specific or just desirable, that they cannot be attributed to all the various forms of coaching (Bachkirova, 2007).

We are aware, therefore, that creating a unique identity of coaching is still an unresolved problem. Nevertheless, we believe that readers should be able to see our position in relation to what coaching is. Our working definition is presented in the very first sentence of this introduction. It is not, of course, free from limitations, but we hope the reader will make use of it while reading this book.

Coaching is used in various contexts, sometimes unconnected with the world of work. However, the use of coaching within organizations has given an immense impetus for the development and growth of the field. Therefore we want to give particular attention to coaching in organizations and suggest the role categorization as a reflection of the pragmatic distinctions that we have observed in organizations:

Line manager as a coach the most difficult and controversial coaching role. Many commentators express doubt as to whether line managers can ever give priority to the coachee's agenda and devote enough time and effort to coach at anything more than a basic level (Ferrar, 2006).

The expert coach many organizations reward experienced employees at all levels for transferring knowledge and skills to others. It is a core part of effective knowledge management. The coaching skills required in this role are arguably too similar to instruction-giving and agenda of the process is as questionable as it is for coaching by the line manager.

The internal professional coach typically someone from human resources, this individual performs many of the same roles as an external professional. However, they may be constrained by authority structures within the organization (for example, in confronting more senior executives) and may be less able to take an independent perspective.

Coaching role model companies such as Kellogg Europe have equipped some of their senior line managers with relatively advanced levels of coaching skills. Their role is to be role models to other line managers for good coaching practice, and to champion the cause of coaching within the organization.

The performance coach typically this is an external professional coach, who specializes in helping the coachee to focus on and achieve task-specific behavioural change over a relatively short period.

The developmental coach usually an external professional coach, who focuses on the broader, longer-term consolidation of leadership competence. Developmental coaches also tend to have a wider remit that encompasses issues such as work-life balance and the crystallization of life purpose.

II. THE KNOWLEDGE BASE OF COACHING

Many different disciplines and areas of knowledge contribute to the emerging knowledge base of coaching. These include management, education, social sciences, philosophy, and psychology. Within each of these established fields of knowledge there are various schools, traditions and approaches. They contain their own set of assumptions about human nature, how people grow and change and how this process can be facilitated. All of them potentially enrich the knowledge base of coaching. However, their diversity can be confusing, particularly for newcomers to the field. Within psychology, for example there are significant differences among existential and solution-focused traditions or between psychodynamic and transpersonal.

Coaches who were educated originally in different fields of knowledge and practice and so were trained according to different traditions, may disagree profoundly on their philosophy and their practice of coaching. When adapted to coaching, each of these disciplines and various schools of thought seems to have significantly different assumptions, not just about coaching but even about what is worth exploring and what is not. The intention of this book is to reflect

the diversity of the field and to illustrate how a multiplicity of approaches can enrich the knowledge base of coaching. We hope this will also help individual coaches to find their way through this diversity towards their own style of coaching.

At the same time we acknowledge that by introducing such diversity we are taking a risk of appearing over inclusive, particularly to those who, while valuing their own approach, take a very strong stand and reject other approaches. The following is therefore our attempt to make transparent our philosophy and main assumptions in relation to the knowledge base of coaching. An overview of the current literature and research on coaching increasingly shows that coaching has been described and explored in at least four major dimensions (Figure 0.1):

- 'I' – a first person perspective on the coaching process by the coach and/or coachee describing individual experiences of both parties involved
- 'We' – a second person perspective that emphasizes the relationship between the coach and the coachee, the role of language and culture in their interaction
- 'It' – more tangible elements of the coaching process, that are able to be observed by a third party and even measured if necessary, such as particular interventions and tools of coaching, specific behaviours and models
- 'Its' – the systems that are present as a background and an influencing force of the coaching process, such as sponsoring organizations and other social and professional groups.

These dimensions correspond to four quadrants described by Wilber (1996, 2000) as essential perspectives that are important to take into account if we want to understand any phenomenon or event that involves human beings. If we look now at various theoretical traditions that are applied to coaching we can see in what corner of this 'map' they would sit more comfortably and could claim their main influence. Individual coaches may also see where the weight of their coaching approach mainly lies, even if they treat as important all of these dimensions.

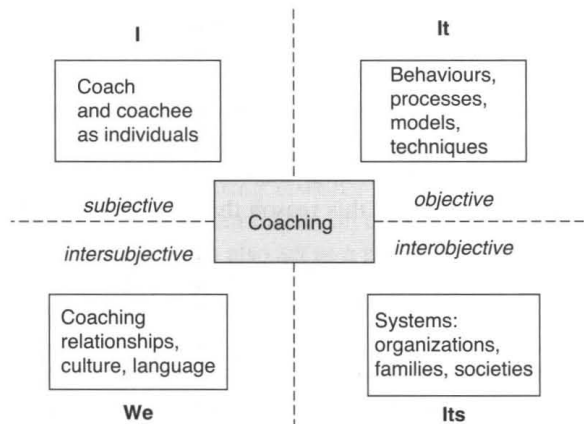


Figure 0.1 Four dimensions of coaching.

For example some coaching approaches in the ‘It’ corner tend to rely on outcome studies of coaching that are based on data that are observable and measurable. They are looking for effective techniques that can be reliably used in coaching interactions. Other approaches lean towards the ‘I’ corner, focusing on how individuals experience an event or process such as a coaching encounter. They are looking for individuals’ feedback on interventions. Within this corner even standpoints such as the transpersonal or spiritual are valuable as they can deepen understanding of what matters to people in coaching. Approaches that lean towards the ‘We’ corner emphasize the role of language in the way we interpret events and experiences and the historical and cultural perspectives that have an impact on these interpretations. They, and also those who defend a systemic approach to coaching from the ‘Its’ corner, are emphasizing how important is an awareness of the complexity of factors that influence the coaching process. They bring to our attention the fact that each author represents a particular cultural and historical perspective and that such a position may differ significantly from country to country and may also change with further development of the coaching field.

Unfortunately, those who position themselves very strongly at some particular standpoint within this structure sometimes reject other perspectives and approaches, thus missing an important angle on the process of coaching. We, however, would like to emphasize the main stance of this overall integral methodological position (Wilber, 2006), which recognizes the value of all dimensions and rejects absolutist claims for the exclusivity of any of them. We believe that the approaches discussed in each chapter can illuminate a particular angle on coaching practice, being sufficiently clear about their philosophical assumptions and ensuring sufficient criticality at the same time. Such an intention allows readers to explore each approach and enables them to decide which, if any, they want to integrate into their own personal model of coaching.

Adult learning theories and their relevance to coaching

In this book, we argue for ‘inclusivity’ and equality of approaches. However, we want at the same time to emphasize a particular theoretical tradition that in our view underpins coaching practice. Adult learning theory is not an approach that can be applied to coaching in the way that, for example, cognitive–behavioural theories or Gestalt principles can. Rather, it underpins all coaching practice. It is for this reason that we present adult learning theories in the introduction.

The definition of learning that we use is one of three outlined by Knowles, Holton and Swanson (2005: 11): ‘the extension and clarification of meaning of one’s experience’. This, it seems to us, is the implicit theme for our clients in any coaching encounter. The concept of change, which is at the heart of coaching, is also inherent in the concept of learning. Any discernible change in behaviour or cognitive development suggests that learning has taken place.

The basic principles of three theories of adult learning are presented here in order to reinforce how they underpin the very nature of coaching. The three theories identified are:

- A. Andragogy, the theory of adult learning introduced by Malcolm Knowles in the 1970s
- B. Experiential learning as propounded by David Kolb (1984)
- C. The transformative learning theory of Jack Mezirow (1990).

A. The assumptions and principles of andragogy

Andragogy is concerned with recognizing the inherent characteristics of adults as learners and using these to guide and support learning. Building on work by Lindeman in the 1920s, together with a variety of other theories from across a range of disciplines, Knowles (1978) devised a set of assumptions about adult learning that would contrast it distinctly with the traditional pedagogical approach to teaching children. These assumptions or principles have come to underpin our views about learning and development and about adulthood. Knowles (1978; Knowles et al., 2005) identified a number of characteristics of adult learners that impact on the way in which they learn or approach learning. Since the 1970s these principles have been assimilated into the learning culture and are now discernible in coaching (Cox, 2006) as the following six main principles:

1. Adults need to know Working with adults as collaborative partners for learning satisfies their need to know what they will be learning, as well as appealing to their self-concept as independent learners. Therefore, in coaching the agenda always belongs to the coachee, or is carefully negotiated so that ownership is theirs and they know the course of the learning.
2. Adults are self-directed As a person matures, they become a more self-directed, autonomous human being (Knowles et al., 2005). However, it is recognized that not all adults have full personal autonomy in every situation: learners still exhibit different capabilities and preferences. Nevertheless, adult learning tends to be facilitated rather than directed: adults want to be treated as equals and shown respect both for what they know and how they prefer to learn. This also explains why specific feedback that is free of evaluative or judgmental opinions is a key feature of coaching.
3. Adults have a wealth of prior experience A mature person accumulates a growing reservoir of experience that becomes an increasing resource for learning and coaches recognize that adults' experiences have a very important impact on their learning. However, as well as being a source of new learning, experience can also act as a gatekeeper, reinforcing mental models and schemas. Therefore, the unlearning process is as important as the learning process. The coach is very well placed to challenge coachees' existing assumptions in relation to new learning or new experiences, thus encouraging both learning and unlearning.
4. Adults learn when they have a need to learn Adults generally become ready to learn when their life situation creates a need to know or understand, e.g. when they need to cope with a

life situation or perform a task. The more the coach can anticipate and understand the client's life situation and respond to readiness for coaching, the more effective their role in coaching will be.

5. Adults are relevancy-oriented Instead of being interested in knowledge for its own sake, adults frequently seek immediate application of what they learn and are oriented to problem solving. They learn best when there is a need to address a pressing issue. For the coach, this suggests that the client may need to work on immediate problems, as well as longer term, developmental issues.

6. Adults are internally motivated Adults are generally more motivated towards learning that helps them to solve problems as they see them, or that results in 'internal payoffs' (Knowles et al., 2005: 199). This does not mean that external motivators, such as requests or encouragement from the line manager, do not have relevance, but rather internal needs and values are more powerful motivators. The coach's role then is to help provide the sense of connection between the client's needs and values, and the results of the coaching.

B. Experiential learning

The second learning theory that we identify as underpinning all coaching practice is the theory of experiential learning, first articulated in the philosophy of John Dewey (1910) and later operationalized by David Kolb (1984). Like coaching, experiential learning can be viewed as concerned with technique and process, rather than with content. Kolb differentiates experiential learning theory from rationalist and other cognitive theories of learning that tend to give primary emphasis to acquisition, manipulation and recall, and from behavioural learning theories that deny any role for consciousness and subjective experience in the learning process. He points out that learning is in fact a continuous process that is grounded in concrete experience.

In experiential learning theory an immediate concrete experience is the basis for observation and reflection. The reflections are then assimilated into a 'theory' from which the implications for future action are deduced. The process can take place incidentally or intentionally. According to Kolb, experiential learning is best viewed as a process and should not be seen in terms of outcomes. It is a constructivist theory that suggests that 'ideas are not fixed and immutable elements of thought but are formed and re-formed through experience' (Kolb, 1984: 26). Learning is seen as a dialectic process that integrates experience, concepts and observations in order to give direction to impulse. This would seem to us to be very much in tune with coaching as a process.

C. Transformative learning

Transformative learning involves a deep, fundamental revision to our beliefs, principles, and feelings: it implies a shift of perception that has the potential to alter our understanding of ourselves and others, and our sense of possibilities (Mezirow, 1990). Transformative learning,

as Mezirow explains, refers to the process by which we transform our ‘taken-for-granted frames of reference (meaning perspectives, habits of mind, mind-sets) to make them more inclusive, discriminating, open, emotionally capable of change, and reflective so that they may generate beliefs and opinions that will prove more true or justified to guide action’ (2000: 7). Meaning perspectives are notoriously difficult to change, but do need to be challenged if deep learning is to occur. Sometimes such a challenge occurs spontaneously through life events and is the focus of the client’s opening agenda, but often, significant challenge is generated by the coach in order to promote the required learning. The challenge, however, generated, results in a ‘disorienting dilemma’.

This dilemma is then followed by discussions of long held beliefs and values. This is one of the most important stages in a transformative coaching situation and involves the critical reflection on the nature and origin of the dilemma. Critical reflection, Mezirow argues, necessitates the suspension of judgment about the truth or falsity of ideas, until a better determination can be made (2000: 13). It is this reflective discourse that is fundamental to transformative learning and leads towards a clearer understanding by tapping experience to arrive at a tentative best judgment. The final stage in the transformative process, following self-examination, is some kind of reorientation that results in deep learning and revised action.

These three adult learning theories provide examples of what we consider to be foundational theories for coaching practice. They are at the heart of all adult learning and development and consequently are at the heart of coaching practices.

III. DESIGN AND STRUCTURE OF THE BOOK

The book consists of three main sections, two of which are presented in the matrix below. The matrix (Table 0.2) illustrates the relationships between theoretical traditions adopted by coaches and the genres and contexts of coaching. Each theoretical approach in the vertical dimension of the matrix is known for its coherent system, which includes background, dominant philosophy and the specific set of processes and tools that coaches use in their practice. At the same time, the same coaches may practice within a variety of contexts, with various categories of clients, under particular conditions and with a specific focus of attention. For example, coaches who consider their approach to be cognitive-behavioural may practice as skills and performance coaches or deliver team coaching; a coach with a distinct person-centred orientation may work as a life coach or career coach. In the same way a transformational coach may be informed by a cognitive-developmental theoretical framework, or an executive coach can be trained in a Gestalt tradition or as an existential coach.

One intention of the book is to make explicit possible links between the theoretical traditions presented and the range of genres and contexts of coaching. That is why each chapter of the book will discuss examples of such combinations, or indicate that some of them are not appropriate. The stars in the matrix indicate that a link is made, whether by the authors of a

particular theoretical chapter on the horizontal dimension or by the authors of a genre or context chapter from the vertical dimension. Readers will find the rationale for these links in the respective chapters of the book.

Section 1

Coaching is no longer seen as an atheoretical enterprise that relies only on common sense and an eclectic combination of tools. A number of theoretical approaches in this section describe the

Table 0.2: The matrix

Section 1 Theoretical traditions of coaching	Section 2: Genres and contexts of coaching										
	Skills & Performance	Developmental Coaching	Transformational Coaching	Executive & Leadership	The Manager as Coach	Team Coaching	Peer Coaching	Life coaching	Career Coaching	Cross-Cultural coaching	Mentoring
The psychodynamic approach to coaching	*	*		**		*				*	
Cognitive-behavioural coaching	**	**	**	**	**	**	**	**	**	*	
The solution-focused approach to coaching	**	**		*	*	*	*				
The person-centred approach to coaching	*	**		*		*	**	**	**		*
The Gestalt approach to coaching	*	*	*		*	**		*		*	
Existential coaching	*		*	*				*	*	*	
Ontological coaching	*	*		*	*					*	
Narrative coaching		**			*	*				*	
The cognitive-developmental approach to coaching		**	**			**				*	
The transpersonal approach to coaching	*	*	*	**		**		*	*		
Positive psychology approach to coaching	**	*		*		*		*	*	*	
Transactional analysis and coaching				*	*	*		*	*	*	
The NLP approach to coaching	**	*		*	*	*	*	*	*	*	

various elements of developmental change in individuals that can be successfully adapted for coaching. Elaborate developmental theories usually include essential elements, such as main concepts and assumptions about human nature, obstacles to development and essential processes and dynamics. Therefore, the chapters in Section One follow a common organizational pattern, so that a reader can easily compare and contrast the various models and approaches:

- introduction to the main concepts and assumptions about human nature from within this tradition, including the history of it and the view on conditions for human development
- tasks and goals of the traditions
- essential processes and dynamics involved
- role of the coach and relationship with a client
- methods and techniques for facilitation of change and development
- application to specific coaching genres and contexts that are presented in Section Two of the book, with examples
- evaluation of the tradition
- suggested further reading with annotation
- references

Admittedly not all approaches have sufficient material to fulfil this structure. Some of them are reasonably new fields of knowledge and are in the process of developing the aspects of a comprehensive theory. The specificity of others does not allow expanding on some of these elements. However, readers will be able to discern the most important elements and will be able to compare theoretical approaches. It should be noted that the list of chapters in this section is not exhaustive in terms of all influential traditions in coaching. They are chosen to illustrate the variety of influences on coaching practice and its knowledge base.

1. The psychodynamic approach to coaching

Graham Lee opens this section with a chapter on the psychodynamic approach to coaching. He describes how this rich influential body of ideas can inform coaches in their pursuit for deepening their practice by contributing to awareness about the working of the unconscious. He explains the origin of such terminology as defence mechanisms, transference and counter-transference with which coaches currently become more familiar without knowing the background and nature of such phenomena.

This chapter suggests that there is a significant layer in our coaching interactions which is mainly beyond our conscious grasp but may influence individual behaviour or teamwork or organizational dynamics.

2. Cognitive-behavioural coaching

Helen Williams, Nick Edgerton and Stephen Palmer describe an approach to coaching that aims at enhancing the quality of a client's thinking with the help of skillful interventions by the coach in collaboration with the client. The approach emphasizes the importance of identifying realistic goals and facilitates self-awareness of underlying cognitive and emotional barriers to goal attainment. It aims to equip the client with more effective thinking and behavioural skills.

The chapter introduces a range of different cognitive models, tools and techniques, such as identifying Performance Interfering Thoughts, reframing of the client's cognitions, teaching clients new ways of thinking and a range of behaviour-focused techniques. It illustrates the use of these methods in health coaching in addition to other genres and contexts included in this handbook.

3. The solution-focused approach to coaching

Michael Cavanagh and Anthony Grant describe an approach that is based on the premise that knowing how a problem arose does not necessarily tell one how to fix it. As a very different course of action it aims at assisting the client to define a desired future state and to construct a pathway in both thinking and action that assists the client in achieving that state.

Coaches who use the solution-focused approach rarely offer generic theory-based solutions, instead they are led by 'what works'. The solutions emerge through useful questions framed by the coach, questions that arise as the result of collaborative thinking and the coach's expertise in the coaching process. The essence of the approach is to help clients to develop the skills of addressing any other concerns and goals in a way that has been discovered through this approach.

4. The person-centred approach to coaching

Stephen Joseph presents a person-centred approach as the one that is based on the most important assumption: the actualizing tendency – a tendency of people to develop in a positive and constructive way when the appropriate conditions are present. He emphasizes that it is a biological tendency and not a moral imperative, and he describes six conditions that the coach needs to provide for coaching to be person-centred.

The message that is clear in this chapter suggests that many coaches who describe their coaching as person-centred, particularly those who combine it with other approaches, while emphasizing the importance of the coach–client relationship, may not fully appreciate the depth of the philosophical underpinnings of this approach.

5. The Gestalt approach to coaching

Peter Bluckert argues that the main principles of Gestalt, such as creative adjustment to a changing environment and a paradoxical theory of change, bring a significant contribution to the understanding and practice of coaching. When applied to the coaching process this approach emphasizes the need for clients' moment-to-moment awareness in relation to their experience, external world and blocks to awareness.

Gestalt philosophy implies high responsibility of the individuals for their behaviour promoting active experimentation with reality in order to reach their goals. It invites clients to explore unfinished business that may cause blocks to further growth. The chapter explains why Gestalt practitioners aim to be more faithful to and honouring clients' own words, meanings and subjective experience and to use their own subjective experience when appropriate as part of an authentic dialogue.

6. *Existential coaching*

Ernesto Spinelli introduces the reader to his version of existential coaching, based on three principles describing the human condition: relatedness, uncertainty and existential anxiety. He identifies the issue of traditional coaching that may be mainly aiming at speedy alteration, reduction or removal of clients' concerns that bring them to coaching. Instead, the focus of existential coaching is primarily on a descriptive exploration of the clients' worldview from the context of their presenting concerns.

The chapter will engage the reader with one of the ways in which to address the tension between certainty and uncertainty by exploring it through the polarities of *meaning* and *meaninglessness*. Such an existential enquiry may help both coaches and their clients to 'own' their experiences, approach, values and beliefs so that their concerns can be more adequately explored.

7. *Ontological coaching*

Alan Sieler describes ontological coaching as a way of working with individuals in their engagement in three interrelated spheres of human existence. These three spheres are language, emotions and physiology (body posture). The coach attempts to be a catalyst for change by triggering a shift in the coachee's 'way of being' to enable him or her to develop perceptions and behaviours that were previously unavailable.

The process starts from developing a shared understanding of the issue the coachee brings to the conversation, and the desired coaching outcomes. It moves consequently to the coach's interpretation of the coachee's way of being through a set of tools that focus on language, emotions and body, which ensures that learning is embodied and consolidated.

8. *Narrative coaching*

David Drake makes a convincing case for an approach to coaching in which clients are seen as *narrators* and the coach helps them to identify new connections between their stories, their identities and their behaviours using the narrative material in the session. Working experientially, contextually and transpersonally, the coach enables clients to generate new options and to create new stories of their lives in action.

Narrative coaches invite people to see their stories from different perspectives. They may help them to notice how stories are constructed and even the fact that they are constructed. These stories may reveal clients' limits but also discover other possibilities about who they wish to be in the world. One of the attractions of working with clients' stories is a potential access to hidden aspects of themselves through bypassing the habitual defences that typically become engaged whenever the situations are approached in the usual head-on way.

9. *The cognitive–developmental approach to coaching*

Tatiana Bachkirova invites the reader to explore an approach that is based on extensive research studies. Cognitive–developmental theories suggest that people differ in their meaning making capacity, which differentiates one person from another more than do their personality types and

preferences. Changes of this capacity occur in a logical sequence of stages throughout the life of the individual. They influence the depth and complexity of what any of us can notice and therefore operate on and change.

Adult development from this perspective is an outcome of internal processes, but can also be further stimulated and facilitated by appropriate support and challenges provided by coaching. Understanding developmental trajectories leaves coaches far better equipped to understand the diverse needs of their clients. It also expands the horizons of the coaches' own development, which plays a significant role in the coaching process.

10. The transpersonal approach to coaching

John Rowan gives an introduction to the approach which recognizes dimensions beyond the personal and implies experiences and values of interconnectedness of all the elements in human systems and between the systems. He starts from clarifying the notion of the transpersonal by considering what it is usually confused with, such as religion, spirituality, new age ideas, and so on. Coaching from the transpersonal perspective is said to enhance awareness of the transpersonal dimension of life and to facilitate the experience of being connected to others in a way that provides feelings of completeness and joy.

The chapter suggests several ways of engaging with various manifestations of the transpersonal, such as creativity. This approach helps to identify what many individuals consider to be essential for meaningful life and work.

11. The positive psychology approach to coaching

Carol Kauffman, Ilona Boniwell and Jordan Silberman describe an approach to coaching in which the distinct feature is a consistent shifting of attention away from problems and weaknesses to opportunities and strengths. The positive psychology movement is based on the growing body of psychological research that challenges old models of understanding human development by focusing on pathology.

The reader will find in this chapter a range of coaching interventions that give a taste of working from such a perspective, inviting one to use a language of strength and vision in addition to the language of issues and concerns. Coaches who are interested in this orientation will find good ground for being selective about what to focus their attention on in order to energize and pull people forward.

12. Transactional analysis and coaching

Trudi Newton and Rosemary Napper describe this interactional approach to coaching as one that is based on several notions such as the ego states, life scripts and interactional patterns. The important assumptions of Transactional Analysis (TA) are that people make current decisions and select goals and methods of their achievement based on past premises that may no longer be appropriate for their own needs and may not be valid. At the same time people are seen as capable of identifying and changing the foundations of their actions: any individual can 're-decide'.

The chapter suggests several ways in which TA can inform coaching practice by providing a thinking framework and by offering accessible language that can be shared with clients for greater understanding of the motivations, interactions and coaching goals.

13. The NLP approach to coaching

Bruce Grimley presents this approach to coaching as one that assists clients in exploring their reality, which may both enable and hinder them. The NLP approach attempts to identify patterns that represent the way individuals construct their realities in order to control their inner experiences in various environmental contexts.

As coachees are often unaware of these patterns, NLP coaches may decide to bring these into the conscious attention of clients or they may choose to work with these at an unconscious level. The chapter gives an overview of a wide range of the NLP techniques that could be useful for coaches, such as matching and pacing; working with well-formed outcomes and anchoring.

Section 2

Applied contexts, forms or types of coaching are referred to in this Handbook as genres and contexts. Genres are forms of coaching that identify the purpose of the coaching in their title, such as performance coaching, developmental coaching or transformational coaching, while contexts refer to the settings or subject matter of the coaching, such as in 'Manager as Coach' or 'Life Coaching'. Each draws on many additional cross-disciplinary theories that are applied in specific contexts, e.g. management, learning, career development and team building.

Section Two (Chapters 14–24) of the Handbook examines the most common genres and contexts of coaching, including the occasionally more directive type of skills and performance coaching, together with the probably less directive types, such as life coaching, developmental coaching, transformational coaching, executive and leadership coaching and cross-cultural coaching. Chapters set out the history and specific features of each context or genre and discuss the role of the coach and the relationship with the client. Each chapter also includes discussion on the relationship of the type of coaching with the theoretical traditions included in Section One and evaluates its strengths and weaknesses.

Each chapter begins with an overview of the genre or context, giving a little of its history, the goals and tasks involved and examining the role of the coach. Chapters also explain the way in which the coaching relationship develops and the relationship with relevant theoretical traditions. Most chapters include descriptions of models or tools that a coach may use in this setting.

14. Skills and performance coaching

Bob Tschannen-Moran describes the goals and tasks of skills and performance coaching (SPC), suggesting that the agenda for SPC is often determined through external, often organizational, requirements. The focus is on meeting a skills or performance need that may have been

identified by the organization rather than the client. Even so, as Bob makes clear, there is a vital need to link the learning need with the coachee's internal desires and ambitions; he argues that there can be no mastery of skills or performance without giving attention to mental, emotional and volitional frameworks, since it is these that govern our performance. SPC is probably the most common form of coaching in an organizational context.

15. Developmental coaching

The integral theme introduced by Bob Tschannen-Moran is continued in Chapter 15, where *Elaine Cox* and *Peter Jackson* explore developmental coaching. In this chapter it is explicitly suggested that many of the different kinds of coaching (from either the theoretical or the contexts/genres dimensions) work towards helping the coachee to develop in some way: there is an element of client development and progress making in all forms of coaching. However, developmental coaching is built on a range of often unarticulated assumptions about individual development and the holistic nature of change that may affect clients. The chapter discusses these assumptions as central to the coaching process and the role of the developmental coach.

16. Transformational coaching

Peter Hawkins and *Nick Smith* explain their conceptualization of transformational coaching, where the aim is to help coachees to make significant change in their life or work, and to make that change speedily. Ideally, they say, this change can be discerned even before a client leaves the coaching room. The authors present the CLEAR process model for facilitating such change. Transformational coaching has applications across coaching contexts, particularly where the need for a meaningful change is pressing.

17. Executive and leadership coaching

In the chapter dealing with executive and leadership coaching, *Jon Stokes* and *Richard Jolly* present an overview of the coaching provided at senior levels in organizations. They explain the challenges that face the executive or leader in relation to developing a strategic perspective, enabling others and balancing the competing forces and interests within the organization.

18. The manager as coach

Andrea Ellinger, *Rona Beattie* and *Bob Hamlin* look at the particular issues facing the manager who also acts as coach. They identify the need to clarify beliefs about managerial roles and capabilities and about learning processes and learners. In addition, the manager needs to have an awareness of where the opportunities for coaching lie in their everyday managerial work and also what constitute effective and ineffective coaching behaviours in this context. The authors draw on their own considerable research in this area to pull together the issues.

19. Team coaching

David Clutterbuck examines the issues surrounding team coaching. He describes his own definition of team coaching as 'a learning intervention designed to increase collective capability and performance of a group or team, through application of the coaching principles of assisted

reflection, analysis and motivation for change'. The contrast in theoretical approach here is between short-term performance orientation and the concept of the team as a learning organism. The importance of team coaching is only just being recognized, although it has always been a vital presence in sport. In work contexts it is now being identified as crucial for team level achievement.

20. *Peer coaching*

Richard Ladyshewsky describes peer coaching, where emphasis is on reciprocal relationships between colleagues with similar experience and responsibility. The focus is generally on expanding or refining work-based skills and competencies. Rick pulls out a number of important issues that have a particular resonance in this context, including trust and confidentiality.

21. *Life coaching*

Anthony Grant and *Michael Cavanagh* introduce life coaching as a way of enhancing well-being in a whole life context, rather than as a strategy to increase functionality in the workplace. They describe it as a 'personal values-based, holistic approach to personal change and development', but note that despite its popularity and potential to individuals and society there is a comparative paucity of research into life coaching, which sometimes reflects on its status within the coaching community.

22. *Career coaching*

In this chapter, *Bruce Hazen* and *Nicole Steckler* describe the particular features and processes of coaching that are specifically designed to enhance career development. Career coaches, they explain, help with the establishment of a 'satisfying marriage of work and current identity where work fits the character, competencies, values and experiences of the coachee'. At the same time, the career coach also seeks to gently disturb the current identity, then design and guide a range of experiments to try and refine or develop that identity to its next stage of actualization.

23. *Cross-cultural coaching*

Geoffrey Abbott discusses the nature and purpose of cross-cultural coaching, suggesting that the successful management of the differences that occur in cross-cultural contexts consists of managing paradox. Abbott argues that cross-cultural coaching can encourage clients towards synergistic, inclusive approaches to conflicting and confusing challenges and should help them to find clarity and commonality despite the complexity of their situations. Cross-cultural coaching should not marginalize culture and give attention to the 'problem' of cultural differences, rather, as Abbott argues, it should support a homogeneous quest for identification of similarities.

24. *Mentoring in a coaching world*

In the final chapter of this section, *Bob Garvey* talks about mentoring. He explains how mentoring has a longer tradition than coaching, but that both activities share many of the same practices, applications and values. He suggests that ultimately it depends on our choice of terminology and the meaning associated with that terminology: mentoring and coaching will

mean different things to different people in different contexts. Bob suggests that mentoring is likely to be closely aligned with coaching. The choice of terminology is often based on sector or organizational preference, rather than a distinct divergence in the goals or tasks of practice.

Section 3

Despite the expansion of coaching as a practice, the concept of coaching as a profession is still relatively novel. Since 2000, a variety of bodies have been established that link coaches together and provide access to focused developmental opportunities. They embrace a number of important functions, such as creating standards, which although not enforced are indicators of good practice for coaches and other stakeholders. Collaborations between these bodies in Europe, for example, has created an emphasis on coaching supervision and it is now becoming increasingly difficult to practice at a senior level in employer organizations without evidence of both supervision and appropriate coaching qualifications. There seems to be, however, a long way to go in establishing coaching as a profession. Section Three (Chapters 25–29) attempts to pull together the main strands of activity and the concerns that have to be addressed in a wider discussion around professionalization of coaching.

25. *The future of coaching as a profession*

David Lane, Reinhard Stelter and Sunny Stout Rostron examine the prerequisites for an occupation to become a profession and assess where coaching fits within these. They explore the question of whether coaching needs to be a profession and/or whether its being an occupation might suffice, offering a more pragmatic solution to the breadth of coaching philosophy and practice. They also draw a useful distinction between being a profession and acting professionally.

26. *Ethics in coaching*

Diane Brennan and Leni Wildflower address the issue of ethics, in the light of both the establishment of ethical codes within all the professional bodies and the increasing collaboration between bodies aimed at harmonizing those codes. Fortunately, the codes are for the most part remarkably similar in concept, even though the precise wording varies.

27. *Coaching supervision*

Peter Hawkins presents an overview of issues around coaching supervision, arguing that coaching without supervision is unethical, in that it exposes clients to potential dangers of which the coach may not be aware. As supervision is also an essential element of the coach's continuing professional development, an absence of supervision can impoverish the quality of reflection-on-practice.

28. *Coaching and mental health*

Andrew Buckley reinforces the issue of client safety by reviewing the relationship between coaching and mental health. The coach with a wide portfolio of clients will inevitably meet

some whose needs extend into the psychotherapeutical. Recognizing these needs and responding appropriately is essential from several perspectives, including the well-being of the client, the reputation of the coach and the reputation of the coaching profession. Coach education in this area is relatively thin, reflecting the lack of clarity in relation to boundaries between coaching and therapy.

29. Continuing professional development for coaches

Diane Stober's review of the state of coach education identifies one of the main reasons for the inadequacy of ethical management, supervision practice and boundary management – the sheer confusion of competing training and qualification providers, each operating from a different and sometimes competing theoretical base and approach. While competence frameworks may help, the establishment of a common knowledge base appears to be a long way off. She argues that only with a substantially expanded evidence base will that knowledge base begin to solidify, and that will require a significant shift in the focus of research away from proving that coaching adds value to investigating the dynamics of relationship effectiveness.

How to read this book

There are a number of ways to read this book. Readers could begin with the chapters on theoretical approaches (Section One) and from there move linearly through the text. Alternatively they may want to pinpoint their particular theoretical or practical approach and so choose a chapter from either Section One or Section Two and pick up links from that first chapter in relation to which theory, genre or context to focus on next. Another way would be to use the matrix as a guide (Table 0.2) and to begin by reading chapters where the starred squares next to their approach are in alignment. Readers who approach the book in this way may find that there are links and associations with theories or practical applications that they had not previously considered.

The following questions may be useful to keep in mind while reading this text:

1. How do you feel when you read the chapter? What resonates with you?
2. What sort of evidence is most persuasive for you?
3. What does your intuition tell you about why you align with the tradition/approach?
4. What is your personal philosophy of change, development and coaching? What helps to formulate it better?
5. How has this personal philosophy been enriched or challenged by what you have read?

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